

YIXUAN (EVEN) XU

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, USA 2024.08 – Present
Ph.D. in Computer Science (Advisors: Zico Kolter and Fei Fang)

Tsinghua University, Beijing, China 2020.09 – 2024.06
Bachelors of Engineering in Computer Science (Yao Class), GPA: 4.0/4.0 (**1/77**)

PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS

Compressed Sensing for Capability Localization in Large Language Models

Anna Bair, **Yixuan Even Xu**, Mingjie Sun, J. Zico Kolter. In *ICML*, 2026.

Antidistillation Fingerprinting

Yixuan Even Xu, John Kirchenbauer, Yash Savani, Asher Trockman, Alexander Robey, Tom Goldstein, Fei Fang, J. Zico Kolter. In *ICML*, 2026.

A Unified Framework for Scalable and Robust Paper Assignment

Michael Cui*, Chenxin Dai*, **Yixuan Even Xu**, Fei Fang. *arXiv preprint*, 2026.
Deployed in **AAAI 2026**, **AAMAS 2026** and **EC 2026**.

Not All Rollouts are Useful: Down-Sampling Rollouts in LLM Reinforcement Learning

Yixuan Even Xu*, Yash Savani*, Fei Fang, J. Zico Kolter. In *TMLR*, 2026.
Selected for **J2C Certification**.
Talk invited at **FAI Seminar** and **Bosch Research Pittsburgh**.

Antidistillation Sampling

Yash Savani*, Asher Trockman*, Zhili Feng, **Yixuan Even Xu**,
Avi Schwarzschild, Alexander Robey, Marc Anton Finzi, J. Zico Kolter. In *NeurIPS*, 2025.
Talk invited at OpenAI, Google and Simons Institute.

Existing LLM Unlearning Evaluations Are Inconclusive

Zhili Feng*, **Yixuan Even Xu***, Alexander Robey, Robert Kirk,
Xander Davies, Yarin Gal, Avi Schwarzschild, J. Zico Kolter. *arXiv preprint*, 2025.

Deviate or Not: Learning Coalition Structures with Multiple-bit Observations in Games

Yixuan Even Xu, Zhe Feng, and Fei Fang. In *AAAI*, 2025.

Improving Community-Participated Patrol for Anti-Poaching

Yufei Wu, **Yixuan Even Xu**, Xuming Zhang, Duo Liu, Shibing Zhu, and Fei Fang. In *AAAI*, 2025.
Selected for **Oral Presentation**.

Aggregating Quantitative Relative Judgments: From Social Choice to Ranking Prediction

Yixuan Even Xu, Hanrui Zhang, Yu Cheng, and Vincent Conitzer. In *NeurIPS*, 2024.

Bidder Selection Problem in Position Auctions:

A Fast and Simple Algorithm via Poisson Approximation

Nick Gravin*, **Yixuan Even Xu***, and Renfei Zhou*. In *WWW*, 2024.
Selected for **Oral Presentation**.

Learning Coalition Structures with Games

Yixuan Even Xu, Chun Kai Ling, and Fei Fang. In *AAAI*, 2024.

Non-excludable Bilateral Trade between Groups

Yixuan Even Xu, Hanrui Zhang, and Vincent Conitzer. In *AAAI*, 2024.

A One-Size-Fits-All Approach to Improving Randomness in Paper Assignment

Yixuan Even Xu, Steven Jecmen, Zimeng Song, and Fei Fang. In *NeurIPS*, 2023.

Selected for **Spotlight Presentation**.

Deployed in **NeurIPS 2024 and 2025**. Covered by **NeurIPS conference blog**.

On the Perturbation Function of Ranking and Balance for Weighted Online Bipartite Matching

Jingxun Liang*, Zhihao Gavin Tang*, Yixuan Even Xu*, Yuhao Zhang*, and Renfei Zhou*. In *ESA*, 2023.

WORKSHOP PAPERS

Evaluating LLM Memorization Using Soft Token Sparsity

Zhili Feng*, Yixuan Even Xu*, Alexander Robey, Avi Schwarzschild, J. Zico Kolter. In *ICLR 2024 SLLM Workshop*.

INVITED TALKS

- **Not All Rollouts are Useful: Down-Sampling Rollouts in LLM Reinforcement Learning** 2025.11
Invited talk at International Seminar on Foundational Artificial Intelligence.
- **Not All Rollouts are Useful: Down-Sampling Rollouts in LLM Reinforcement Learning** 2025.07
Invited talk at Bosch Research Pittsburgh.

HONORS AND AWARDS (SELECTED)

- **Jane Street Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention** 2026.03
Awarded to 28 students worldwide in 2026
- **Huaying Deben Fellowship** 2024.08
Awarded to 3 students in Changzhou, China in 2024
- **Outstanding Graduate of Beijing** 2024.06
Awarded to 5% graduates in Beijing
- **Valedictorian of Yao Class** 2024.06
Honored to talk at the Yao Class Commencement
- **Yao Award (Silver Medal)** 2023.09
Awarded to 3 students in Yao Class in 2023
- **National Scholarship of China** 2021.10
Awarded to 0.2% students in China in 2021
- **Huaying Fellowship** 2020.09
Awarded to around 20 students in Changzhou, China in 2020

COMPETITIVE PROGRAMMING (SELECTED)

- **ICPC World Finals, Bronze Medal** 2024.04
Ranked 10th with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang
- **ICPC North America Championship, Silver Medal** 2025.05
Ranked 2nd with teammates Shiyuan Feng and Junzhao Yang
- **ICPC Asia-East Continent Final Contest, Second Place** 2022.07
Ranked 3rd with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang
- **CCPC National Final, Gold Award** 2022.04
Ranked 3rd with teammates Binwei Yan and Renfei Zhou

- **National Olympiad in Informatics, Gold Medal** 2019.07
Ranked 8th in China
- **Asia-Pacific Informatics Olympiad, International Gold Medal** 2018.05
Ranked 7th in Asia Pacific

TEACHING

- **Advanced Topics in Machine Learning and Game Theory (Carnegie Mellon University)** Spring 2026
Teaching assistant (Instructor: Fei Fang)
- **Design and Analysis of Algorithms (Tsinghua University)** Fall 2023
Teaching assistant (Instructor: Ran Duan)

SERVICE

- **Conference Reviewing**
AAAI (2025), ICLR (2025, 2026), ICML (2025, 2026), NeurIPS (2024, 2025)
- **Yao Class Research Seminar** Fall 2023 – Spring 2024
Host with co-organizers Renfei Zhou, Kaiyue Wen, Jingxun Liang, Zhaokai Pan, and Jiahong Shen
- **Drop-in Tutoring for STEM Courses of Tsinghua University** Spring 2022 – Fall 2023
Volunteer with over 100 hours of tutoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Apple** 2026.05 – 2026.08
Research intern managed by Philipp Krähenbühl
- **Wizard Quant** 2024.01 – 2024.01
Quantitative research intern on future trading, ranked 1st out of 9 interns
- **Carnegie Mellon University** 2023.02 – 2023.09
Research intern advised by Fei Fang and Vincent Conitzer
- **Beijing Academy of Artificial Intelligence** 2021.04 – 2021.09
Research intern advised by Yang Yuan

SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** C & C++, Python, LaTeX, Matlab
- **Community Engagement:** 132.5 hours of officially recorded volunteering work at Tsinghua University
- **Hobbies:** Guitar Playing (Level 10 Amateur), Writing, Singing, Competitive Programming
- **Languages:** Chinese (Native), English (Fluent, TOEFL 114, GRE 336 + 5)

HONORS AND AWARDS (OTHER)

- **Gold Reviewer of ICML 2026** 2026.05
Awarded to 25% reviewers in ICML 2026
- **Outstanding Graduate of Tsinghua University** 2024.06
Awarded to 2% graduates in Tsinghua University
- **Outstanding Graduate of IIIS** 2024.06
Awarded to 20% graduates in Yao Class

• Wang Dazhong Scholarship Awarded to 1 student per department in Tsinghua University in 2023	2023.09
• CCF Outstanding Undergraduate Awarded to around 100 students in China in 2023	2023.09
• Four-star Zijing Volunteer of Tsinghua University Awarded to students with over 120 hours of volunteering work in Tsinghua University	2023.05
• Jiang Nanxiang Scholarship Awarded to 1 student per department in Tsinghua University in 2022	2022.10
• Tsinghua Xuetang Talents Program Scholarship Awarded to students within the Tsinghua Xuetang Talents Program	2020.10
• Second-class Freshman Scholarship of Tsinghua University Awarded to freshmen with outstanding academic competition performance in high school	2020.10

COMPETITIVE PROGRAMMING (OTHER)

• ICPC World Finals, High Honor Ranked 19th with teammates Shiyuan Feng and Junzhao Yang	2025.09
• ICPC East Central NA Regional Contest, First Place Ranked 1st with teammates Shiyuan Feng and Junzhao Yang	2024.11
• CCPC Weihai Regional Contest, Third Place Ranked 3rd with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang	2022.11
• ICPC Asia Kunming Regional Contest, First Place Ranked 1st with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang	2022.04
• Meituan Programming Contest, Third Prize Ranked 13th with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang	2021.07
• THU Student Programming Contest, Gold Award Ranked 4th with teammates Sunli Chen and Ziqian Zhong	2021.05
• ICPC Asia Shanghai Regional Contest, Gold Award Ranked 3rd with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang	2020.12
• ICPC Beijing Xiaomi Invitational Contest, First Place Ranked 1st with teammates Sunli Chen and Junzhao Yang	2020.11
• Asia-Pacific Informatics Olympiad, Gold Medal Ranked 38th in China	2019.05
• National Olympiad in Informatics, Gold Medal Ranked 25th in China	2018.07
• China Team Selection Competition, Gold Award Ranked 11th in China	2018.05
• CCF NOI Winter Camp, Gold Award Ranked 57th in China	2018.02
• National Olympiad in Informatics, Silver Medal Ranked 83rd in China	2017.07
• Asia-Pacific Informatics Olympiad, Gold Medal Ranked 43rd in China	2017.05
• China Team Selection Competition, Silver Award Ranked 136th in China	2017.05

- **CCF NOI Winter Camp, Gold Award** 2017.02
Ranked 27th in China
- **Asia-Pacific Informatics Olympiad, Silver Medal** 2016.05
Ranked 88th in China